Draft cover letter — for author review; not sent

Dear PLOS ONE Editors,

Please consider the Research Article **"Longitudinal motor-imagery EEG decoding: Frozen baselines, supervised recalibration, and task-measurement reliability."**

This secondary analysis uses 18 published participant identities across six sessions from Kumar2024. The original study already investigated fixed/adaptive common spatial patterns and first-run recalibration. Our narrower contribution separates classifier-only from full spatial-filter/classifier updating with the same 19/20 current-session labels and examines whether available task measurements justify an update decision.

The original primary 12-participant contrast favored full refitting over frozen decoding by 7.42 percentage points (95% participant-bootstrap interval 2.49–12.48). The secondary equal-label-budget contrast favored full refitting over classifier-only updating by 5.47 points (2.17–8.91), without promotion to a primary endpoint. All fixed neural seeds, negative results and collapsed predictions remain reported. Weak independent source-query EEGNet performance limits a cross-session-drift explanation. New QC sensitivity preserves missing-class limitations; event tracing qualifies the endpoint as cue-anchored task-label decoding, not isolated sustained imagery. Prior test exposure remains explicit. No validated adaptive gate, skill-retention effect or clinical efficacy is claimed.

The review materials provide scientific methods, a separate audit appendix and machine-readable saved-result reproduction. Original-study ethics and consent are distinguished from the pending institutional determination for this secondary analysis. Specific license activation and final author approval remain pending; this draft does not assert completed submission eligibility.

Sincerely,

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